Prahlin Portfolio Work Log - November 3, 2026

Compiled summary for Tuesday, November 3, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio after the November 2 carousel, stack, release, navigation, and Productivity Hacks record; explicitly verifying the United States Eastern date; running the customary project reader; extracting and studying the complete pre-existing PDF worklog archive; refining wide and narrow sticky-navigation behavior; adding a localized content fade beneath the navigation without moving hero media; strengthening workflow hierarchy, borders, typography, focus, and rail continuity; reorganizing Work Space and Work Tools into balanced hardware, development, QA-device, and design groups; completing responsive alignment and factual device / workstation details; making Productivity Hacks controls actionable and content-aware; and redesigning all five hack cards as rounded, bordered, alternating triangles with concurrency-focused Multi- copy.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahlin Portfolio worklog format: compact opening summary, source-material review, baseline and goals, feature-grouped implementation details, committed-source sequence, validation, files and artifacts, follow-up notes, and output-artifact close. The record preserves the archive's dense technical voice, explicit repository evidence, dated footer treatment, and distinction between committed source, local verification, documentation output, and deployment state.

Coverage begins after portfolio_worklog_november2.pdf and documentation commit 8997635. Five Portfolio source commits completed November 3: 70db31f, ec6b9b9, 7cf8cae, 35fac20, and be3ac37. At documentation time, HEAD, main, origin/main, and origin/HEAD all resolve to be3ac37784f87781e6c2596c24a9b33c5ed60003. The reader-refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt is the only modified tracked file before this PDF is added. No additional source commit, GitHub Actions dispatch, Hostinger synchronization, public deployment, external message, store submission, or ancillary-repository write was performed during this worklog pass.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Date verification: checked an external UTC-05:00 clock, which reported Tuesday, November 3, 2026 at 10:41 PM. This agrees with America/New_York after the November 1 daylight-saving transition, so the worklog correctly uses November 3 and EST rather than UTC-04:00 or the execution host's date.
- Project reader: ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt with current source, assets, repository state, deployment notes, PDF inventory, and standing workflow instructions.
- Worklog archive: enumerated and extracted all 60 pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDFs with pdftotext, from portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf through portfolio_worklog_november2.pdf. Before this artifact, the archive contained 332 pages and approximately 174,187 extracted words.
- Archive comparison: reviewed every PDF's filename and same-day Part suffixes, title and date cadence, page count, opening-summary density, section sequence, feature-grouped bullet voice, validation language, files-touched record, follow-up continuity, output-artifact close, repeated footer, page numbering, and document metadata.
- Nearest baselines: read November 2 in full and compared November 1, October 22, October 18, September 29 Part 2, representative August records, and the July 11 first entry. November 2 remained the direct source baseline; November 1 and October 22 supplied the closest workflow, navigation, and interactive-section history.
- PDF conventions: confirmed mature output as US Letter portrait at 612 x 792 points, unencrypted black Helvetica-family text on white, compact margins, bold section headings, a dated first-page title, repeated dated footers, right-aligned page numbers, and Codex author / creator metadata.
- Repository evidence: reviewed the five November 3 commit messages, bodies, timestamps, statistics, aggregate diffs, synchronized branch refs, current navigation controller, workflow styles, Work Space / Work Tools data, Productivity Hacks component, generated snapshot, and local runtime state.

Baseline Status Before November 3

- The November 2 baseline had a full-page sticky navigation, but the wide bar retained its original asset scale and required better sticky-state interpolation, brand-to-CASES spacing, right-edge protection, and an intentional return to its default size before the scroll reached the page top.
- The landing content remained fully visible beneath the translucent sticky bar. This reduced navigation legibility when hero copy or imagery entered its zone, while broad page-wide opacity changes risked dimming content that was nowhere near the navigation.
- My Workflow already contained five interactive stages, three image-backed points per stage, exclusive focus, compact selectors, and five-tone surfaces. Inactive panels, number / name tabs, inter-row borders, header typography, and the long vertical rail still needed stronger hierarchy and pixel-level continuity.
- Work Space and Work Tools retained too many labels, device-platform distinctions, separate tool categories, heading arrows, and fixed-height whitespace. Hardware specifications and QA-device naming also required factual cleanup and a more comparable desktop / portrait grid.
- Productivity Hacks already provided five color-coded cards, merged A / B / C indicators, hover-only autoplay, shortcut copy, and Automation A. Its paragraphs, headers, selectors, card heights, click behavior, and empty variants still needed structural refinement before the later triangle experiment.

Goals for November 3

- Enlarge the sticky navigation on wide layouts without clipping its rightmost content, compressing unrelated link spacing, shifting hero media, or changing the protected narrow-navigation design.
- Fade only content entering the navigation's vertical zone, support the same logic in portrait layouts, and restore the wide navigation smoothly and early during upward scrolling.
- Make active workflow sections unmistakable while keeping inactive stages legible, equalizing all inactive subsections, repairing tab-to-panel seams, and rendering the vertical rail as one neutral uninterrupted element.
- Reorganize Work Space and Work Tools into four aligned hardware, development, QA, and design groups.

- Complete Productivity Hacks with actionable selectors, uniform heights, protected copy, and a reversible triangle layout.

Work Completed - Sticky Landing Navigation

- Added LandingNavFrame as a client-side sticky-state controller. It measures the navigation frame, tracks scroll position through requestAnimationFrame, exposes sticky progress through CSS custom properties, and cleans up scroll / resize listeners without moving the hero composition.
- Scaled the wide navigation's brand, Prahl.dev wordmark, dividers, and links by 15 percent in the sticky state. Used a final 100 ms transition so the change begins immediately while remaining interpolated rather than springing, bouncing, or stepping between sizes.
- Protected the rightmost CONTACT area from clipping by reallocating horizontal room around the brand side. CASES moved closer to the P / Prahl.dev block, but the remaining links and dividers retained their established spacing instead of being uniformly compressed.
- Removed the divider immediately left of CASES and preserved the exact narrow / portrait character sequence. The correction avoided introducing a desktop-only glyph that contradicted the compact navigation treatment.
- Started the return to the default navigation size earlier during upward scrolling. The wide bar now reaches its original scale by the time the scroll returns to the top instead of beginning its shrink only after hero content has already resettled.
- Kept reduced-motion behavior intact and limited wide asset scaling to the intended desktop aspect-ratio range. The narrow navigation retained its own wrapping, height, spacing, and non-resizing scroll behavior.
- Prevented navigation interpolation from changing the hero's document flow. The device frames and screenshots no longer visibly translate during vertical scrolling as a side effect of the bar's measured size.

Work Completed - Localized Navigation Underlay Fade

- Added a navigation-zone opacity treatment rather than dimming the entire landing page. Content remains at normal visibility until it physically enters the sticky bar's vertical region.
- Tuned the final fade so content reaches approximately 33 percent opacity behind the bar and approaches zero as it reaches the screen's top edge. This protects navigation legibility without placing a dark veil over unrelated content farther down the viewport.
- Applied the same underlay logic to portrait and narrow aspect ratios while protecting their existing navigation dimensions, row wrapping, typography, and scroll behavior.
- Separated the fade calculation from the navigation's wide-only resizing state. Narrow layouts receive the opacity behavior even though their bar does not enlarge during scrolling.
- Preserved normal content opacity when the page is at rest and outside the navigation zone, honored reduced-motion preferences, and cleared stale development output during iteration when accepted source changes did not appear locally.

Work Completed - Workflow Hierarchy and Active State

- Strengthened active stages with full color, brighter panel fills, more legible imagery and type, accent outlines, and tone-matched shadows. The active stage now reads as a deliberate focal surface rather than a minor opacity change.
- Raised inactive-stage visibility incrementally through several review passes, stopping below the earlier overly bright state. The final balance keeps stages 01 through 05 readable without competing with the centered active stage.
- Equalized all three inactive subsections within both active and inactive overall stages. The first panel no longer receives a built-in visibility advantage before focus; only the currently active point becomes the focal panel.
- Made inactive panel headings slightly lighter in weight than active headings. Replaced the awkward display treatment used by titles such as BUILD and TESTING with typography closer to the landing page's other section headers.
- Made left and right panel borders visible at rest instead of revealing them only on hover. Preserved subdued fills, underlays, imagery, and selector states consistently across the three columns.
- Reconciled the top number / stage-name row with the lower three-panel frame. Iterative width adjustments removed one-pixel horizontal mismatches across 01, 02, 03, 04, and 05 without creating a gap, skew, or isolated focal seam.
- Kept the long vertical workflow rail permanently in its inactive visual state. Active stages no longer illuminate the entire line, which previously drew attention away from the focused panel.
- Changed the rail from green to the landing page's off-white header tone without increasing its visibility. Rebuilt responsive rail segments to remove dots, scuffs, doubled joins, and discontinuities between stage boundaries.

Work Completed - Work Space and Work Tools Reorganization

- Removed the Peripherals header, icon, and explanatory white copy, then removed the decorative white arrows between Work Space and Work Tools. The section now relies on its two primary headings and grid structure instead of ornamental direction cues.
- Consolidated the prior tool columns into four major groups: HARDWARE, DEV / CODING, QA DEVS, and ART / DESIGN. Green icons and multiline group labels were brought closer together and aligned against each group's first white subsection heading.
- Rebuilt HARDWARE around Primary Workstation and Secondary Peripherals. The workstation now lists MacBook Air, 15-inch, 2025, M4, 10-core CPU (4P + 6E), 16GB unified memory, and 256GB SSD without unrelated display, operating-system, or graphics prose.
- Restored concise peripheral evidence under Secondary Peripherals: two WCV 15.6-inch 1080p IPS displays, a 3TB WD My Book, and an Atolla 240W 8-Port hub. Renamed the former External Monitors category to match the broader inventory.
- Merged tools into Development & AI (VS Code, Xcode, PyCharm, Codex, GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT, and Claude) and Testing & Workflow (Expo Go, iOS Simulator, GitHub, and Jira), avoiding deeper Dev Stack duplication.
- Reorganized QA devices by form factor rather than operating system. Smartphones and Tablets use white subsection headers; device names,

screen sizes, and relative Small / Standard / Large classifications use the shared gray term style.

- Removed Samsung from the smartphone labels and preserved small visual breaks between Android and iOS device groups. The final phone list covers Galaxy A3 4.5-inch Small, Galaxy S21 FE 6.4-inch Standard, Galaxy S20 Ultra 6.9-inch Large, iPhone 14 6.1-inch Standard, and iPhone 12 Pro Max 6.7-inch Large.
- Corrected the tablet inventory to Galaxy Tab A 8.0-inch Small, iPad Air 2 9.7-inch Standard, and iPad Air 13-inch Large. The iPad Air 2 name replaced the ambiguous duplicate iPad Air entry.
- Created ART / DESIGN with Visual Design and Motion & Media. Added Figma, FigJam, Figma Dev Mode, Photoshop, Illustrator, Premiere Pro, After Effects, and Media Encoder while matching the development and QA column cadence.
- Reduced excessive fixed whitespace, then restored a controlled amount between the upper and lower subsection rows. Aligned white headings, gray terms, icons, labels, paragraph breaks, and the bottom-row optical offsets across wide and portrait layouts.

Work Completed - Productivity Hacks Content and Interaction

- Added Automation B: MCPs allow code changes, diff inspection, and commit pushes while on the go. Kept the text on Automation rather than Shortcuts and highlighted GitHub Actions and MCPs in each card's assigned accent color.
- Moved all five active paragraphs below their placeholder preview boxes instead of above them. Preserved command-line breaks and bold shortcut prefixes while giving normal prose the full card width.
- Moved merged auto-navigation indicators to the top-right region of the rectangular-card phase, aligned them to each icon box's top edge, and horizontally centered both indicators and headings within the icon-to-right-edge space.
- Aligned card-title bottoms to icon-box bottoms and made each selector segment directly clickable or tappable. Added grouped accessibility labels and pressed state while retaining hover-specific automatic A / B / C cycling.
- Used Automation A as a hidden sizing reference for all five cards and all three versions. This protected a common height as copy changed and prevented variant selection from shifting the section vertically.

Work Completed - Alternating Triangular Productivity Cards

- Replaced the five rectangular hack cards with reversible triangular variants: Shortcuts, Multi-, and Tuning point upward; Automation and System point downward. The alternating orientation preserves the original five-color order and relative horizontal sequence.
- Built scalable SVG clip paths for both orientations and synchronized visible SVG outlines with the same geometry. Repeated refinements produced strongly softened tips and base corners, color-matched borders, and tone-aware focused outlines rather than sharp polygon cuts.
- Scaled the final desktop triangles to approximately 390 x 338 pixels, maintaining a near-equilateral 1.155:1 base-to-height ratio. Compressed card centers inward so the full visual envelope remains aligned to the existing 1180-pixel site shell.
- Separated the upward and downward rows by 70 pixels to support the larger triangles without edge collisions. Shortcuts, Multi-, and Tuning share one exact vertical baseline; Automation and System share the opposing row.
- Moved upward-card selectors to the broad bottom base. Repositioned icons, headings, previews, paragraphs, and downward-card selectors according to the safe width available at each vertical slice of the triangle.
- Prevented text, preview boxes, icons, or selectors from clipping against sloped edges across desktop and portrait layouts. Responsive caps preserve the stacked narrow layout without allowing the desktop enlargement rules to create horizontal scrolling.
- Renamed Terminal to Multi-. Added A: Multiple VSCode sessions ensures that multiple projects are worked on in tandem; B: Multiple AI Bots ensure that multiple apps are work on concurrently; and C: Multiple Monitors eliminates the occurence of workspace clutter.
- Verified all three Multi- variants at 1920 x 900 and 390 x 844. Each paragraph's scroll height matched its client height, confirming that the new concurrency copy remained fully visible.

Committed Source Sequence

- 70db31f - Refined responsive landing navigation and scroll behavior. Added LandingNavFrame, 15-percent wide sticky scaling, 100 ms interpolation, CASES spacing and divider cleanup, localized underlay fading, early reset behavior, hero stability, and snapshot refresh.
- ec6b9b9 - Refined workflow section hierarchy, typography, and framing. Strengthened active surfaces, equalized inactive panels, cleaned title typography, reconciled tab / panel geometry, and rebuilt the off-white non-illuminating workflow rail.
- 7cf8cae - Reorganized Work Space and Work Tools sections. Consolidated hardware, development, QA, and design groups; corrected device and workstation details; removed arrows and excess whitespace; and aligned responsive subsections.
- 35fac20 - Refined workspace tooling and productivity interactions. Completed grid alignment and hardware facts; added MCP copy and accent keywords; repositioned hack copy; made selectors actionable; and protected uniform card heights.
- be3ac37 - Redesigned Productivity Hacks with alternating triangular cards. Added rounded SVG silhouettes and borders, final responsive geometry, protected internal placement, the Multi- title, and concurrency-focused A / B / C copy.
- At documentation time, HEAD, main, origin/main, and origin/HEAD all resolve to be3ac37784f87781e6c2596c24a9b33c5ed60003. All five source commits are synchronized; no additional source commit or push was performed while generating this record.

Validation Summary

- Verified the Eastern date externally at UTC-05:00 and reconciled it with America/New_York after the daylight-saving transition.
- Ran the standard project reader and reviewed the regenerated snapshot, source tree, Git state, deployment notes, PDF inventory, and standing instructions.
- Extracted all 60 prior worklogs, totaling 332 pages and approximately 174,187 words, and compared their naming, structure, style, metadata, validation language, and output closure.

- npm run check completed successfully; TypeScript reported no errors.
- npm run build completed successfully with Next.js 16.2.10 and Turbopack. The optimized build compiled, TypeScript passed, seven static pages generated, and /, /aboutdev, /articles, /projects/alla-vostra, and /projects/cinerific were reported as static routes.
- Local route checks returned HTTP 200 for / and /aboutdev after the development server was restarted. Headless Chrome measurements confirmed the final 1180-pixel triangle envelope, near-equilateral geometry, row alignment, responsive selector placement, and unclipped Multi- copy.
- git diff --check passed for the application-source scope. The only tracked modification at PDF composition time is the reader-generated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt; its generated embedded-source formatting was not manually rewritten.
- No GitHub Actions run, Hostinger synchronization, public deployment, store submission, external communication, or ancillary-repository modification was performed during this documentation pass.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/LandingNavFrame.tsx - new sticky-state measurement, scroll progress, frame variables, resize handling, and cleanup behavior.
- app/ProductivityHacks.tsx - clickable selectors, protected sizing reference, accent-keyword rendering, Automation MCP copy, rounded triangle definitions and outlines, Multi- title, and concurrency variants.
- app/page.tsx - landing navigation integration, Work Space / Work Tools inventories, hardware and device facts, group labels, and retained workflow structure.
- app/globals.css - sticky navigation scaling and fading; workflow focus, borders, typography, rail, and tab geometry; Work Space / Work Tools layout; Productivity Hacks interaction; triangular clipping, borders, sizing, placement, and responsive rules.
- app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx - localized cleanup associated with the navigation / landing interaction pass.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - reader-generated Portfolio snapshot refreshed before PDF composition.

Follow-Up Notes

- Continue treating the triangular Productivity Hacks layout as a reversible experiment. Preserve the 1180-pixel horizontal envelope, near-equilateral ratio, shared upward baseline, softened SVG geometry, and internal safe zones if card copy changes.
- Complete the intentionally empty System and Tuning variants only with specific productivity evidence. Keep card-local autoplay and direct selector controls synchronized.
- Preserve the navigation-zone fade as a localized treatment. Do not reintroduce page-wide opacity changes or hero-media translation during scroll.
- Keep the workflow rail neutral and continuous; future active-state work should remain inside the stage tabs and panels rather than illuminating the page-length connector.
- Maintain hardware and QA-device facts as concise evidence rather than duplicating the deeper My Dev Stack section. Recheck screen-size classifications when devices are added or replaced.
- Resolve the previously documented GitHub billing lock before treating synchronized refs as evidence of a successful Hostinger deployment.

Output Artifact

- Generated /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_november3.pdf using the established lowercase-month, unpadded-day naming convention. No Part suffix was needed because no earlier November 3 root-level Portfolio worklog existed.
- The title and filename use Tuesday, November 3, 2026 after explicit EST / UTC-05:00 verification.
- The artifact uses US Letter portrait pages, black Helvetica-family text on white, compact technical bullets, repeated dated footers, right-aligned page numbers, and Codex document metadata.
- The synchronized Portfolio source baseline is be3ac37784f87781e6c2596c24a9b33c5ed60003. The reader-generated snapshot and this PDF are the documentation outputs from this pass.
- No application source change, additional commit, public deployment, external message, or ancillary-repository update was performed during worklog generation.